THE COMPLETE GUIDE

Rebuy
Shop Manual

Run a shop whose customers come back — without remembering a single one of them.

For owners, managers and staff · Version 1.0 · November 2026

REBUY · RETENTION OS
Kampala, Uganda

The complete guide for shop owners and their teams

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> i **How to read this manual**
>
> Bold text is something you click or type. Anything in a grey box is an example you can copy. Where the app behaves differently for a clinic than for a shop, the clinic version is in Section 8 and clearly marked.

SECTION 01

What Rebuy does

One idea, and everything else follows from it.

Most shops lose customers without noticing. Someone buys soap in March, you never hear from them again, and by August they are buying soap somewhere else. It rarely feels like a loss — it feels like a normal quiet week.

Rebuy fixes exactly that, and nothing else. You tell it **how long what you sell lasts**. When someone buys it, Rebuy starts that clock. When the clock runs out, it sends them a message — on WhatsApp, by SMS or by email — that reads like a person wrote it.

The three things Rebuy tracks

What	What it means	Why it matters
Restock clock	Days until a customer runs out of what they bought.	The single best moment to hear from you.
Customer health	new · loyal · at risk · lapsed · lost	Who needs attention this week, and who does not.
Recovered revenue	Sales that happened after a Rebuy message.	Whether this is working, in shillings.

What Rebuy does not do

Rebuy is not a full accounting system and not a stock-management system. It does not do payroll, tax, or supplier orders. If you already use something for those, keep using it — Rebuy sits beside it and handles the part those tools ignore: **the customer who stopped coming back**.

> ✓ **The one rule**
>
> If you get nothing else right: make sure the duration on each product is honest. A wrong duration sends a reminder on the wrong day, and a reminder that arrives at the wrong moment is worse than none at all.

SECTION 02

Getting started

From nothing to your first automated reminder, in about ten minutes.

1

Sign in

Open Rebuy in your browser and choose **Continue with Google**, or set a password with an email address. If you were invited to a team, use the link in that invitation on your phone — it signs you straight in.

2

Create your shop

First-time sign-in takes you to a short setup screen: shop name, what you sell, currency and where you are. This becomes the name on your messages, so use something your customers recognise — *Nakato's Salon*, not *nakato_co_2024*.

3 **Add products and their durations**

This is the important one. See Section 3.

4 **Add or import your customers**

Type them in one at a time, or upload the spreadsheet you already keep. See Section 7.

5 **Connect a channel**

WhatsApp, SMS or email. See Section 6.

6 **Record a few sales**

Each sale started a clock. Once a clock runs out, the first reminders appear in your queue for approval.

> ! **You do not have to do this in one sitting**
>
> The dashboard shows a setup checklist and tells you the single next thing worth doing. Nothing breaks if you stop halfway — Rebuy simply does not send anything until a channel is connected.

SECTION 03

Products & services

The duration is the whole engine. Get this right and the rest is automatic.

Open **Products & services**. Every item has a **duration in days**: how long one purchase lasts your customer.

Product	Duration	Reminder arrives
Loaf of bread	2 days	Day 2 — before they would normally rebuy
Bar of soap	30 days	Day 30
Cooking gas cylinder	45 days	Day 45
Bag of cement	60 days	Day 60
Dental check-up	180 days	Day 180

When in doubt, go slightly **shorter** than the real duration. A reminder that arrives a day early is a helpful nudge; one that arrives a week late reads like you have only just noticed them.

> ✓ **Watch the first few weeks**
>
> Look at your queue in week one and check the timing looks sane. If a reminder says someone is out of bread after two days, and they buy once a month, fix the duration then — it corrects every future reminder at once.

SECTION 04

Recording sales

One action, four ways in — pick whichever fits the moment.

Method	Best for	Where
Quick add	One sale at the counter, several times an hour	Sales → New sale
Import a sales book	Catching up on a week that is already written down	Import data → Sales
Receipt photo	You have a pile of paper receipts	Import data → Receipts
Till export	You already use a POS that exports CSV	Import data → Sales

Every sale records four things: **who**, **what**, **how much**, and **when**. Rebuy uses the product's duration to work out the date the customer will run out, and that date is what drives everything else.

> i **Record the sale against a real customer**
>
> A sale with no customer attached still counts in your revenue, but it cannot start a reminder — Rebuy has nobody to talk to. At the counter, take the phone number. That number is the entire asset.

SECTION 05

Customers & segments

Grouping people so you message the right ones — and leave the rest alone.

Rebuy sorts every customer into five health states, automatically:

State	What it means	What usually helps
New	Bought once, recently.	A second purchase. Do not over-message.
Loyal	Buying on a regular rhythm.	Protect them. Reward them, lightly.
At risk	Overdue, but they have not vanished.	One reminder, timed well.
Lapsed	Gone quiet for a long stretch.	A win-back offer with a deadline.
Lost	Very overdue and unreachable.	One last honest attempt, then stop.

A **segment** is a saved group — for example *at risk, bought soap, Kampala*. Open **Segments & campaigns** to build one and send to everyone in it at once. Campaigns are previewed before they send, so you always see the exact message and the exact number of people before anything leaves.

SECTION 06

Reminders & the inbox

Approval, timing, and what to do when someone replies.

A reminder moves through four states:

```
queued → approved → sent → delivered (or failed)
```

Open **Reminder queue** to see what is about to go out and what already went. If your shop is set to **approve first**, nothing leaves until a person says so — useful for the first fortnight while you build confidence.

Channels

Channel	Best for	Setup
WhatsApp	Most Ugandan customers; supports replies	Business number connected
SMS	Customers without smartphones; always lands	Sender ID + credits
Email	Receipts, invoices, formal clients	SMTP settings

The **Inbox** collects every reply in one place. When a customer replies to a WhatsApp reminder, it does not vanish into your phone — it appears in Rebuy, threaded by customer, so whoever is on shift can answer it. Quick replies are worth setting up: half of all replies are answering “how much?” or “is it open?”.

> ! **Reply fast or do not ask**
>
> A reminder invites a reply. If nobody answers for two days, you have spent goodwill and gained nothing. Decide before you switch a channel on who is watching the inbox.

SECTION 07

Importing your data

Keep the spreadsheet. Rebuy will read it.

Open **Import data**. Rebuy accepts CSV and Excel files (.csv, .xlsx, .xls) up to a few thousand rows. You do not need to rename your columns first — it looks for common names and shows you what it matched **before** importing anything.

A typical customer sheet:

```
Name, Phone, Last purchase, Amount, Product
Grace Nakato, 0772123456, 2026-03-02, 45000, Bar soap
Peter Okello, +256701987654, 2026-02-11, 120000, Cooking gas
```

Rules that save you a second attempt:

Rule	Why
Phone numbers must be real	123 is not a number. Rebuy rejects it and tells you which row.
One customer per row	Two names in one cell becomes two customers with the same phone.
Dates as dates	2026-03-02 or 02/03/2026 both work; “last month” does not.
The preview is not the import	Nothing is saved until you confirm the dry run.

> ✓ **Import in small batches first**
>
> Import 50 rows, look at the result, then do the rest. It is much easier to spot a column that mapped wrongly in 50 rows than in 5,000.

SECTION 08

Client records & recalls

For clinics, dental practices, opticians, physiotherapists — and hospitals.

A shop sells things that run out. A clinic provides **services that come due**. The clock is different, so Rebuy treats this differently — but the principle is identical: know what is due, and reach the person politely.

Set up a service with a recall interval

Service	Recall interval
General consultation	as needed
Dental check-up & scaling	180 days
Antenatal review	28 days
Immunisation (child)	30 days
Annual health screening	365 days

When you record a visit, Rebuy schedules the next recall by itself. When you mark a recall **seen**, it chains the following one. You never maintain the calendar by hand.

The three screens

Screen	What you do there
Client records	Search clients, open one to see their history, upload a register.
Recalls due	Work through who is due: mark **booked** or **seen**.
Retention	See the percentage who came back, by service and by branch.

Privacy — this part is not optional

If you handle health information, Rebuy is strict by default, and you should be glad it is:

Protection	What it means in practice
Encrypted at rest	Date of birth, file number, condition, address and notes are stored encrypted. A database copy does not expose them.
No diagnoses in messages	A reminder may say “you are due for your dental check-up”. It will never carry a diagnosis or a test result. Messages that would are held back, not sent.
Every read is logged	Opening a client record is recorded: who, when, from where. Export is recorded as a bulk disclosure.

✕ **Never put a diagnosis in a reminder**

A message is read on a shared phone, in a matatu, by whoever picks it up. “Your HIV result” or “your pregnancy review” can do real harm. Rebuy blocks these automatically — do not try to word around the block.

SECTION 09

Retention & reports

Whether any of this is working, in numbers you can act on.

Open **Reports** for the retail view, or **Retention** in the clinic view. The headline number is the same idea in both: **of the customers who came due, how many came back?**

Number	What it tells you
Retention rate	The share of due customers who returned. Rising is good.
Recovered revenue	Money from sales that followed a Rebuy message.
Response rate	Share of messages that got a reply. Falling means the wording or timing is wrong.
By segment	Which group is leaking. Usually one, not all.

i **Read the first month loosely**

Early numbers are noisy because your customers are not yet spread across the clock evenly. Give it three cycles of your longest product before drawing conclusions.

SECTION 10

Team, billing & troubleshooting

The boring section that saves the phone call.

Inviting your team

Open **Team**. Only the owner can invite. An invitation is a single-use link that expires in seven days. Two roles exist: **owner** (everything, including billing) and **staff** (day-to-day: sales, customers, inbox).

Plans

Plan	Monthly	Customers	Messages / month
Starter	UGX 49,000	500	2,000
Growth	UGX 129,000	3,000	15,000
Scale	UGX 299,000	20,000	100,000

When something looks wrong

Symptom	Almost always
No reminders are appearing	No product has a duration set, or no sale has a customer attached.
A reminder arrived on the wrong day	The product duration is wrong. Fix it once; every future reminder corrects.
Messages say “failed”	Channel not connected, or the customer's number is not a real number.
A customer got two messages	Two products with different durations were bought on different days — this is correct behaviour.
Import rejected rows	The preview tells you the row number and the reason. Fix those rows and re-import; nothing already imported is duplicated.

✓ **Before you call for help**

Note the shop name and the approximate time of the problem. Almost every issue is answerable from the audit trail in under a minute with those two facts.

End of the Rebuy Shop Manual.